

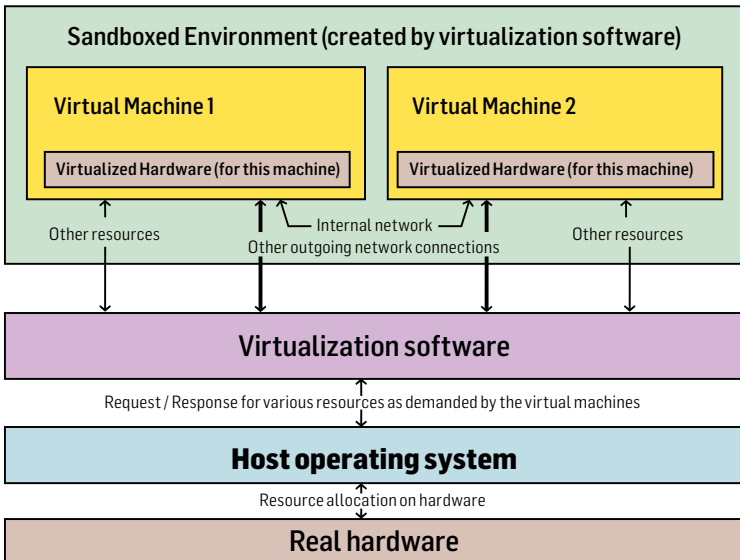


Figure 1: How virtualization works

hardware being real, it most certainly depends on the hardware that's actually installed on the computer. Without a powerful computer, virtualization can be a big pain.

When virtualization gets an OS running over the top of another, the bigger picture has the following things happening inside:

- ▶ The real (or the HOST) operating system is running and managing a few applications and services.
- ▶ One of those applications and services is the virtualization software.
- ▶ Virtualization software is running another (or may be more than just one) operating system (the GUEST operating system).
- ▶ The Guest operating system is thinking that it's running on a computer which it is not!
- ▶ There are probably some applications being run on the guest operating system that are trying to put some load on the hardware as well.
- ▶ All the load being created by the Guest operating system is being sent to the real hardware via the Host operating system.

Processor

You can clearly tell that there are a bunch of operations going on. All these